

Under the scheme, DeitY and Bureau of Indian Standards (BIS) can randomly select samples of registered electronic goods to ascertain whether these goods conform to the specified standard.

"The scheme provides that no person shall by himself or through any person on his behalf manufacture or store for sale, import, sell or distribute specified electronic goods which do not conform to the specified standard and do not bear the words "Self declaration - conforming to IS (Indian Standard)" after obtaining registration from the BIS," a press release said.

"Substandard or defective goods which do not conform to the specified standard will be deformed beyond use by the manufacturer and disposed of as scrap," it added.

India aiming for 9GW solar capacity by 2017

India has released a draft policy with the goal of building 9GW grid-connected solar plant capacity by 2017, which is actually more than eight times its current capacity.

The overall plan includes auctioning of 1650MW photovoltaic capacity by the central government in the next financial year, grants to cut project costs and loosening of curbs on purchase of equipment from overseas—according to the draft published on the website of Ministry of New and Renewable Energy (MNRE). The policy will be funding the solar industry for the first time with direct grants covering as much as 40 per cent of the up-front cost of building projects.

Developers submitting bids that need the least funding will win solar auctions. Grants would be paid in stages as projects reach milestones, to prevent developers from bidding too low and ignoring plant performance.

The draft also raises the possibility of doing away with a rule that requires project developers to buy crystalline cells and panels from local manufacturers such as Indosolar, Websol Energy System and Jupiter Solar Power. The responsibility for building 60 per cent of the targeted 9 GW will be shifted to individual states.

Loans for solar projects to get cheaper

India's bid to promote use of solar energy has received further boost with the World Bank sanctioning \$200-million line-of-credit (LoC) to India Infrastructure Finance Company Ltd (IIFCL) for lending to solar power projects in India. This development will provide cheaper loans for solar projects in the country.

"The LoC is available for all renewable energy projects but "our priority is solar," said S.K. Goel, chairman and managing director of IIFCL. IIFCL has already been a major lender to solar projects with investment of around Rs 5.7 billion. It is learnt that the government-owned non-banking finance company has co-lent to 210 MW of solar projects.

While part of the \$200-million LoC will be used for replacing existing rupee loans of IIFCL's solar borrowers, the rest of the funds will be used for lending to other projects.

Snippets

Analog Devices tops in mitigating climate change

Analog Devices has received the highest score among analogue semiconductor manufacturers in Carbon Disclosure Project's (CDP) S&P 500 Climate Change Report 2012. Each year, CDP distributes a questionnaire and scores companies on the quality of their disclosure and performance on actions taken to mitigate climate change. ADI's CDP report score rose to 76 in 2012 from 49 in 2011.

Symmetry to sell AMD products

Under an agreement with AMD, Symmetry Electronics will immediately begin to promote, sell and support the full line of AMD embedded products including the newest family of AMD Embedded R-Series accelerated processing units. This development underscores AMD's commitment to expanding its presence and penetration in embedded market.

BHEL to invest Rs 20 billion in solar gear plant

Bharat Heavy Electricals Ltd (BHEL) is looking to set up a 600MW solar equipment manufacturing facility with an investment of Rs 20 billion. Its decision to set up solar equipment manufacturing unit comes at a time when solar products are being imported in India at a cheaper cost, hampering the growth of domestic producers.

"Initially, we are going to concentrate on module production, which is the end product. Later, we will manufacture solar cells and (other) materials," said BHEL chairman B.P. Rao. Later on, the company would also get into silicon wafers, solar cells and solar modules manufacture.

20 solar giants in India

With the announcement of the draft second phase of Jawaharlal Nehru National Solar Mission (JNNSM), the government is once again giving an aggressive push to the solar industry, keeping the power shortage of the country in mind.

After a period of lull, the momentum has once again picked up, and by 2017, India will have 4000 MW of solar energy under JNNSM and 2500 MW under state solar policies.

In its January 2013 issue, Electronics Bazaar, published by EFY Group, has listed out 20 solar giants in India, who are not only contributing to a major transition in the country—from conventional power to solar energy—but also doing good business in the market. The list includes Azure Power, Central Electronics, Chemtrols Solar, Emmvee Solar Systems, Euro Multivision, Indosolar, Jupiter Solar Power, Lanco Solar, Mahindra Solar One, Moser Baer Solar, Photon Energy Systems, PLG Power, Premier Solar Systems, Reliance Industries Ltd-Solar Group, Surana Ventures, Tata Power Solar Systems, Titan Energy Systems, Vikram Solar, Websol Energy System and XL Energy.

Intex to set up mobile handset facility in HP

Intex Technologies plans to set up a mobile phone manufacturing facility at